

Day 6 — Panchanga — Five Limbs

Module: Moon Phases and Tithi · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: identify the five components: tithi, vāra, nakṣatra, yoga, karaṇa.

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *amāvasyā* (IAST: amāvasyā; lit. “new moon”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **Define pañcāṅga.** Five (*pañca*) limbs (*aṅga*) of the Indian calendar:
 - *tithi* — lunar day (Module focus so far)
 - *vāra* — weekday (7-day cycle, *ravivāra-śanivāra*)
 - *nakṣatra* — lunar mansion (27 divisions of ecliptic)
 - *yoga* — Sun-Moon longitudinal sum (27 named yogas)
 - *karaṇa* — half-tithi (11 named karaṇas)
2. **Source.** Sūrya-siddhānta, *Pañcāṅga-prakaraṇa* sections.
3. **Read a published pañcāṅga together.** Show today’s row. “*Identify each of the five aṅgas.*” Note that the pañcāṅga also lists *muhūrta* (auspicious hours), *rāhu-kāla*, *yamaṅga* — derivative computations.
4. **Modern parallel.** Astronomical observational data (NASA / IMCCE) provide the *raw inputs* (Sun-Moon longitudes); the pañcāṅga *interprets* these through the 5-limb framework. The astronomy is universal; the framework is Indian.

5. **Critical-thinking discussion.** “*Pañcāṅga* has been used for ritual timing for ~2000 years. What does that tell us about (a) the durability of the framework and (b) the limits of inferring causation from co-occurrence?”

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *10-Day Moon Observation Diary* (see [activities/](#)). Today’s slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Panchanga — Five Limbs.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#) for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 *pañcabhūta*).